

Neosapien Neo 1

Great at remembering, but not quite ready to be forgotten

We have become very good at having conversations and very bad at remembering them. On a busy workday, you can sit through meetings, speak with dozens of people, and still struggle to remember who said what by the time evening comes. Of course, taking notes helps, but writing everything down can mean you are busy documenting instead of actually listening. This is the problem devices like the Neosapien Neo 1 are designed to solve. Worn around your neck, it listens to conversations and turns them into transcripts, summaries, and action items that you can search later. Sounds cool in theory, right?

Well, I wore the Neosapien Neo 1 for two weeks, using it in a variety of situations, to see how well it handles real-world conversations.

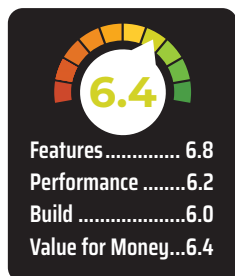
DESIGN AND BUILD

The Neo 1 is a 20-gram pendant that sits around your neck on a metal chain. There is no screen, speaker, or complicated set of controls. A double tap starts or stops recording, while a white LED confirms that the device is listening.

I initially liked the simple design of the Neo 1 because it does not look like a typical gadget. However, after using it for two weeks, I have mixed feelings about the build quality. The black paint on my unit has already started chipping under normal use, while the plastic body doesn't inspire much confidence. The parts around the chain have also started to loosen.

The chain itself can be annoying. It gets tangled in clothes, and while removing it, it got stuck in my hair.

₹12,999



RECORDING CONTROLS

The double-tap control on the Neo 1 is a nice idea because you can start recording without opening your phone. But there is no vibration or sound to tell you that the tap actually worked. This means I often found myself looking down at the LED to confirm whether it was recording. For a device designed to let you tap and forget about it, this feels like an unnecessary interruption.

There is another issue that bothered me more. You need to keep an eye on whether the device has gone into sleep mode. The Neo 1 is supposed to be something you can wear and forget, but I found myself checking it occasionally to make sure it was still active.

TRANSCRIPTION

I tested the Neo 1 on the Delhi Metro, and while the transcription was generally decent, it struggled in noisy environments. Sometimes, it picked up nearby conversations, making it hard to tell what I was saying from what other people were saying.

I noticed a similar issue while traveling in public places that have a noisy environment. I found that the device occasionally mixed conversations from other passengers and people nearby with our own. However, its performance improved a lot in quieter and more controlled settings.

The Neo 1 worked especially well indoors with very little background noise, such as during meetings. In these situations, it captured conversations more clearly and produced much more reliable transcriptions.

Hindi transcription also worked well in my testing. It was able to accurately capture proper nouns, including company names, which can often be difficult for speech-to-text systems. The company says the Neo 1 supports more than 140 languages, although I wasn't able to independently verify that claim.

AI SUMMARIES

The raw transcript is useful when you need to search for something, but I found the AI-generated summary much more practical for everyday use. Instead of reading through an entire conversation, you get a short summary along with important points and action items. If you have two different discussions in one recording, the Neo 1 can also separate them into different memories.

For me, this was the feature that truly made the device feel like more than just a microphone. During closed-room meetings, I use it to quietly listen to the meeting details and later check the AI summaries that have been provided to me as a clear recap of the conversation. Doing so saved me a significant amount of time and made it much easier to stay focused on the meeting instead of worrying about taking notes.

NEOSAPIEN NEO 1 SEARCH

The search function is probably the feature I would miss the most if I stopped using the Neo 1. You do not have to remember which meeting something was discussed in. If you remember the topic, you can search for it and find the